

## **Teacher card**

A festival of light: Diwali / BUILD\_RE\_A2\_W01

Outcome: Explore one festival of light and explain one meaning linked to it.

Evidence to retain: F: one symbol matched to one meaning.

## **Forty minute route**

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.  
Pause time is flexible.

## **Preparation**

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Use age-neutral materials; focus on meaning rather than trivia; model respectful language and diversity within traditions.

## **Access and regulation**

Image-led; minimal reading; matching before writing; drawing/label option; verbal/scribed response; reduced symbol set.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

This is learning about religion and worldviews, not worship. Nobody is asked to share a personal belief, family detail or loss.

## **Assessment**

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner's individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner's evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

## **Model and answers**

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: What can the light of a diya stand for?

Evidence: B The diya: A diya is a small lamp. Rows of diyas are lit at Diwali. For many people the light stands for good overcoming evil and for hope.

Think aloud: Good overcoming evil, and hope.

Check: Does every family celebrate Diwali in the same way? No. Families celebrate in different ways.

## **Arrival answers**

1. A special time when people celebrate
2. A special time when people celebrate
3. Good overcoming evil, and hope.
4. No. Families celebrate in different ways.

## **Shared activity reasoning**

1. A lit diya — Hope. Card B: the light stands for good overcoming evil and for hope.
2. A rangoli pattern by the door — Welcome. Card C: many families make rangoli to welcome guests.
3. Rows of lamps in the dark — Good overcoming evil. Card B: light wins over darkness.

## **Exit responses**

What can the light of a diya stand for? Good overcoming evil, and hope.

Does every family celebrate Diwali in the same way? No. Families celebrate in different ways.

## Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Arrival: 4 retrieval questions from Autumn 1. Starter: mystery light images. I Do: introduce a festival such as Diwali through an easy-read story and images. We Do: match symbols such as diya/rangoli/light to meanings such as hope, welcome or good. You Do: make a simple symbol-meaning response. Exit ticket: 'Light can mean...'.

### Look for

F: one symbol matched to one meaning.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

### Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

### Source credits

Hindu American Foundation Diwali <https://www.hinduamerican.org/diwali>

Sikh Coalition introduction to Sikh beliefs and practice  
<https://www.sikhcoalition.org/about-sikhs/>

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources\_and\_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.